

How to run the desk

Everything reception does on the booking system, and the few things a doctor does. Written against the screens as they are today. If a button here is not on your screen, you are signed in with an account that does not have it — ask whoever set up your login.

THIS APP — RECEPTION

Where bookings arrive

Patients book on the hospital website. Those bookings land on the reception desk screen. You approve them, book for people who telephone, keep each doctor's consulting hours correct, and copy every booking into Klinique.

KLINIQUE — CLINICAL

Where the record lives

Prescriptions, consultation notes and patient history stay in Klinique. This app does not hold them and is not trying to. One patient must never have two records that disagree.

The one rule that matters most

A booking is not finished when you approve it. It is finished when it is **in Klinique**. The **To enter in Klinique** tab is the list of bookings that are not there yet. If that list is empty at the end of the day, nothing has been lost. If it is not, somebody will arrive for a clinic that has never heard of them.

The desk screen is in English only. That is deliberate — it is an internal screen used by a few trained people, and an operational word translated loosely here would cost more than it saves. The patient-facing website is in English, Tamil and Hindi.

GETTING IN

EVERY SHIFT

Sign in to the desk

1. Open the hospital website in Chrome.
2. Add `#desk` to the end of the address and press Enter.
3. Type your username and password, and press [Sign in](#).

The desk is not in the website's menu on purpose — patients should never stumble into it. **Bookmark the `#desk` address** so you are not typing it every morning.

At the top right you will find [Password](#) to change your own password (it asks for the current one first, so nobody can change it at an unattended counter) and [Sign out](#). Sign out at the end of your shift.

Turn on the chime and the alerts

Two switches at the top right. Both start off, because a browser will not make a sound or raise an alert until a person asks it to, and a chime is not always wanted in a waiting room.

- **Chime** — a sound when a new booking arrives. Click it once and you will hear it immediately, which is how you know it worked.
- **Alerts** — a desktop alert even when the desk is behind another window. Chrome will ask permission; say yes.

Beside them sits **LIVE** or **CHECKING**. **Live** means new bookings appear by themselves. **Checking** means the connection dropped and the screen is re-reading every 45 seconds — it still works, just slower. A desk that has quietly stopped updating looks exactly like a quiet morning.

YOUR DAY, IN ORDER

1 **Open Today**

Everything booked for today, earliest first. This is the list you work from at the counter.

2 **Clear New requests**

Bookings made online overnight. The slot is already held — approving tells the patient they are expected, so send them the written confirmation at the same time.

3 **Empty To enter in Klinique**

Copy each one across and tick it off. Do this early; it is the step that goes wrong when the counter gets busy.

4 **Work through To call back**

People who asked for a doctor who is not bookable online. Ring them and give them a time.

5 **Check Follow-ups due**

Patients a doctor asked to see again who have not come back. Overdue ones are at the top.

6 **Glance at Alerts**

Anything that failed to send. If the list is clean, the day is clean.

WHAT EACH TAB IS FOR

The number on a tab is how many items are waiting in it.

TAB	WHAT IS IN IT	WHAT YOU DO
To enter in Klinique	Bookings not yet copied into Klinique	Copy across, then tick Entered in Klinique
Klinique	Klinique itself, opened inside this screen	Work in it as normal, or open it in a new tab
New requests	Booked online, nobody has approved yet	Approve each one
Today	Today's appointments, cancellations removed	Mark Seen ; Tell patient sends details
Book for a caller	An empty booking form	Book for someone on the telephone or at the counter
To call back	People who asked to be called	Ring them, then Give them a time
Schedules	Every doctor's days, hours, fee and room	Keep correct; open a doctor for online booking
Repeat requests	Patients asking for the same prescription again	A doctor decides these — see Part 2
Follow-ups due	Patients due back within seven days	Ring them and Book them in
Alerts	Messages the system tried to send	Check nothing failed; fix the reason
Doctor contacts	Each doctor's mobile number and consent	Save, verify, record consent

NEW REQUESTS

Approve a booking that came in online

Each row shows the time, the doctor, the patient's name, their mobile and the booking reference. Under it, the date and the reason they gave.

1. Press **Approve**.
2. Go to **To enter in Klinique** and put it into Klinique.

The slot was already held from the moment they booked, so nobody else could take it. Approving does not reserve anything — it **tells the patient they are expected**.

ANY APPOINTMENT · AFTER BOOKING

Send the patient their appointment in writing

Every appointment row has a **Tell patient** button, and so does the green **Booked** bar after you book for a caller — which is the best moment to use it, while they are still on the line.

1. Press **Tell patient**.
2. Pick the language — **EN**, தமிழ் or हिंदी. It remembers your last choice.
3. Read the message shown, then press **WhatsApp** or **SMS**.
4. Your phone opens with the message already written. Press send.

It goes **from your own phone**, not from the hospital — so there is nothing to set up and nothing to pay. The patient gets the reference, the doctor, the date and time, the address and the number to call, in their own language.

Copy the message is there for a counter machine with no WhatsApp and no SIM — paste it wherever you need. A cancelled appointment sends different wording automatically, so nobody is cheerfully confirmed for a visit that is not happening.

Copy a booking into Klinique

Until Klinique give the hospital an API key, somebody types it across. This tab makes that as fast as it can be.

1. Press **Open Klinique** to get the portal in another tab.
2. Press **Copy all** to take the whole booking as one labelled block — patient, phone, age, gender, doctor, date, time, visit type, fee, reason.
3. Or tap any single field to copy just that one. A tick appears when it has copied.
4. When it is in Klinique, press **Entered in Klinique**.

Tick it, every time. The tick is the only record that a booking has been transferred. Without it the only way to know is to search Klinique for each one.

When the list is empty the tab shows **Everything is in Klinique**. That is the state it should be in when you go home.

Book for someone on the telephone

1. Choose the **doctor**. The fee is shown beside each name.
2. Choose the **date**. The free slots for that doctor on that day appear underneath.
3. Tap a slot.
4. Fill in name, mobile (10 digits), age, gender and the reason for the visit.
5. Press **Book appointment**.

A reference like **DH-KZHFK8** comes back. **Read it out to the caller** and ask them to bring it. It is how the booking is found again at the counter.

Only doctors with a published schedule appear here

If the doctor you want is missing, they have no consulting hours set. Go to **Schedules**, fill in their days and times, and press **Save and open booking**.

TO CALL BACK

Turn a callback request into an appointment

These are people who wanted a doctor who cannot yet be booked online. The row shows who they want and why, with their number as a button you can tap to dial.

1. Ring the number on the row.
2. Press **Give them a time**. The booking form opens with their details already filled in.
3. Pick a date and slot, then **Confirm this appointment**.

The doctor cannot be changed here — this **converts their existing request** rather than making a second one, so they never appear twice.

TODAY

Mark people as they are seen

Only the moves that are legal from a row's current state are shown, so you cannot put an appointment into a state the system will refuse.

STATE	MEANS	YOU CAN
PENDING	Booked online, not yet approved	Approve · Seen · Cancel
CONFIRMED	Approved and expected	Seen · Cancel
REQUESTED	A callback request, no slot yet	Cancel
COMPLETED	The patient has been seen	Nothing — it is finished
CANCELLED	Called off	Nothing — book a fresh one instead

Cancelled appointments drop out of **Today** straight away, so the list on your screen is always the people actually coming.

SCHEDULES

Make a doctor bookable online

At the top of this tab a bar reads «n» of «n» **doctors can be booked online**. Until a doctor appears there, patients can only ask for a callback.

1. Find the doctor. A tag reads **BOOKABLE** or **CALLBACK ONLY**.
2. Tap the days they consult.
3. Fill in morning from/to and evening from/to. Leave a session blank if they do not sit then.
4. Enter the fee and the room.
5. Press **Save and open booking** — that saves *and* opens them for online booking. **Save** alone keeps them on callback only.

If several consultants share the same hours, use the **bulk** panel above the list to set them all at once rather than opening twenty rows.

Medical registration numbers

Each doctor's row has a **Medical registration number** box. Their qualifications are shown publicly on the website, so the number belongs beside them. Take it from the hospital's records — **never guess**. An unverified number is worse than none, which is why the box is left empty rather than filled in with something plausible.

Let the system message a doctor

A doctor is only ever messaged once **all three** of these are true. Saving a number alone does nothing.

1. **Number saved** — type the 10-digit mobile, press [Save number](#).
2. **Verified** — confirm the number reaches the right person, then press [Mark verified](#).
3. **Consent recorded** — type how they agreed (for example “*agreed at HOD meeting, 4 March*”) and press [Record consent](#).

The tag then turns from [NOT REACHABLE](#) to [REACHABLE](#). [Pause alerts](#) stops messages without deleting the number — use it when a doctor is on leave.

ALERTS

Find out why a message did not go

Each row is one message the system tried to send. [Send queued now](#) pushes anything still waiting.

The reason is printed on the row. Here is what to do about each one.

IT SAYS	DO THIS
No mobile number on file	Doctor contacts → save the number
Number not verified yet	Doctor contacts → Mark verified
Consent not recorded	Doctor contacts → Record consent
Doctor has alerts switched off	Nothing — they chose this. Ring them instead
NOTIFY_DESK_PHONE is not configured	Not yours to fix — pass it to whoever runs the server
Appointment no longer exists	Nothing — it was cancelled and deleted

Nothing reaches a patient on its own

The hospital has no SMS gateway, so **no message is sent automatically**.

Use [Tell patient](#) on the appointment row — one tap sends it from your phone by WhatsApp or SMS. Read the reference out loud as well.

If you forget all of this

Press [Show me around](#) at the top of the desk. It walks you through the screen you are looking at. There is also an assistant on the desk that answers questions and can jump you to the right tab.

Short, because most of your work is not here.

Your clinical work stays in Klinique

Prescriptions, consultation notes and patient history are written in Klinique and only in Klinique. This app deliberately has no second place to write them. Two records that can disagree about a patient is a worse problem than any convenience it would buy.

WHAT THIS APP DOES FOR YOU

SIGNING IN

Your login

Your username is `doctor` followed by your identifier — Dr Deepan G is `doctordeepan-g`. Your password was given to you once when the account was made; it cannot be looked up afterwards.

1. Open the website, add `#desk`, sign in.
2. Press `Password` at the top right and set your own password the first time you sign in.

Lost it? Nobody can read it back to you — it is stored so that it cannot be. Ask whoever runs the server to reset it (Part 3).

SCHEDULES

Your consulting hours, fee and room

This is what decides whether a patient can book you online at all, and what they are told they will pay.

- **Days and sessions** — patients are only offered slots inside these.
- **Fee** — shown to the patient before they book.
- **Room** — printed on their appointment slip.
- **Medical registration number** — shown publicly beside your qualification. Please give reception yours; most of the roster is still blank.

If your hours change, tell reception the same day. A patient booked into a session you are not sitting is the one failure this system cannot recover from by itself.

REPEAT REQUESTS

Decide a repeat prescription

A patient asking for the same medicines again. The row shows their name and number, the diagnosis, what was prescribed, and anything they wrote.

- **Approve and re-issue** — issues a **new** prescription dated today. The original is left untouched.
- **Decline** — needs a reason typed in the note box first. **The patient reads that note**, so write it for them, not for the file.

This sits on the reception screen, but it is a clinical decision. **Reception must not press either button.**

Patients you asked to come back

Everyone you asked to return who has not been seen since, due within seven days, overdue at the top. Reception rings them and books them in from this list.

The list is only as good as what was written in the prescription. If you want somebody back, **put the return date on it** — that is what puts them here.

Not for the counter. These are run on the machine hosting the app, from the `server` folder.

ACCOUNTS

```
# A reception account npm run create-staff -- --username reception --role staff # An
```

Every password is shown exactly once

They are stored as salted hashes, so nothing can be read back afterwards. Write them down as they appear, hand them out, and destroy the note. If you lose the output, reset the account rather than trying to recover it.

THE DATABASE

```
# Apply any new schema changes npm run migrate # Take a backup npm run backup
```

Back it up somewhere other than this machine

Backups written beside the database are not backups. Copy them off the machine on a schedule, and check once that a copy actually restores.

When something looks wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
The tag says CHECKING , not LIVE	The live connection dropped. The screen is re-reading every 45 seconds.	Nothing urgent. Press Refresh if you are waiting on something.
Signing in to Klinique inside the app does not stick	The browser is blocking cookies for a site shown inside another. Safari does this by default.	Use Open in a new tab . It works the same and keeps you signed in.
A doctor is missing from the booking form	They have no consulting hours set, so there is nothing to offer.	Schedules → fill in days and times → Save and open booking .
“Nothing free on this date”	Every slot that day is taken, or the doctor does not sit that day.	Try another date, or check the doctor's days in Schedules.
No Approve button on a row	It is already approved, or already finished.	Read the tag on the row — it says which.
A patient says they got no message	Correct. Nothing is sent automatically — there is no SMS gateway.	Open the appointment and press Tell patient .
The screen is empty and will not load	The desk cannot reach the server.	Press Refresh . If it stays empty, the server is down — call whoever runs it.

Not yet true, and nobody should say it is

The website does **not** claim NABH accreditation, and must not until somebody has checked the entry on the register. Most doctors still have no registration number on file while their qualifications are shown publicly. Both of these are for the hospital to settle before the site is advertised.

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Written against the desk screen as it stands today. If the screen and this page disagree, the screen is right and this page is out of date — say so, and it will be

corrected. Prints on A4, one part per page.